[INCH-POUND]

A-A-1659A
December 27, 1991
SUPERSEDING
A-A-1659
January 15, 1981

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

ENVELOPE, PACKING LIST (DOUBLE SAFETY FOLD)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description as a replacement for Style 1, All Classes, of Federal Specification PPP-E-540.

This description covers water resistant envelopes with a double fold closure for the protection of packing lists and other shipping documents.

1. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS:

A) Construction. Envelopes furnished under this description shall be made from an opaque water resistant material which has a Bursting Strength of not less than 40 pounds per square inch when tested in accordance with TAPPI T 403 and an average Internal Tearing Resistance in each direction of not less than 100 grams when tested in accordance with TAPPI T 414. Envelopes shall be flat style, with a double safety fold. Each envelope shall be lightly scored 7/8 ± 1/8 inch from, and parallel to, the open end to provide the first fold. Another scoring shall be made between 1 and 1-1/8 inches below and parallel to the first scoring to provide for a second fold. When the envelope is closed, the double safety fold shall be opposite the face or printed side of the envelope. Six holes, each with a diameter of 1/8 to 3/16 inch shall be centered along the side edges of the envelope, 3 on each side. They shall be located so that when the double safety fold is closed on the scored lines, each set of 3 holes coincides to form, in effect, a single hole through each side of the double safety fold. When specified, a legend shall be printed on the front of the envelope in black letters, centered to within ± 1/2 inch. Each letter shall be not less than 1/2 inch high. Envelopes shall pass the Water Resistance Test specified in Section 2.

B) Dimensions. Dimensions of the envelopes shall be inside dimensions, exclusive of flaps, folds, seals, or attachment holes. The opening shall be along the shorter side. Dimensions shall be as specified, with a tolerance of ± 1/8 inch.

DISTRIBUTION STATEMENT A: Approved for public release; distribution is unlimited.

FSC 8105

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C) Workmanship. Envelopes shall be uniformly constructed and free from pinholes, tears, cuts, wrinkles or any other defect which may affect their appearance or serviceability. When a printed legend is required, it shall be clear, legible, and waterproof.

2. QUALITY ASSURANCE:

A) Responsibility for Inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the Commercial Item Description where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

B) Physical properties. The physical properties of the material from which the envelopes are made shall be tested in accordance with the below methods. Sampling for these tests shall be in accordance with TAPPI T 400, Sampling and Accepting a Single Lot of Paper, Paperboard, Fiberboard or Related Product.

PHYSICAL PROPERTY	METHOD	REQUIREMENT LOCATION
Bursting Strength	TAPPI T 403	Para. I. A
Tearing Resistance	TAPPI T 414	Para. I. A

C) Sampling. Envelopes and shipping containers shall be sampled in accordance with MIL-STD-105, as indicated below, for the cited examinations and test.

1) Examination of the envelopes for Construction, Dimensions, and Workmanship. The lot size shall be expressed in envelopes. The sample unit shall be 1 envelope. The Inspection Level shall be S-2, the AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective.

2) Testing of the envelopes for Water Resistance. The lot size shall be expressed in envelopes. The sample unit shall be 1 envelope. The Inspection Level shall be S-1, the AQL shall be 2.5 percent defective. Each sample unit shall be tested for water resistance in accordance with ASTM D 951. One sheet of 9 pound (17 X 22 - 500) manifold paper folded in quarters shall be inserted into the envelope to simulate a packing list. The unfolded area of the sheet shall be not less than 2 times the area obtained by multiplying the length times the width of the envelope as

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determined in Section 1. B). The manifold paper may be cut to size or sheets may be taped together when necessary to make a simulated packing list of the proper size. The envelope shall be carefully closed along the scored lines of the double safety fold and secured to a piece of wood by nailing or tacking through the aligned holes onto the wood. The wood, with the envelope attached, shall be placed in a vertical position (90 ± 10°) in the test room or chamber and exposed to a medium intensity (2 ± 1/2 inches per hour) spray of water at 73.4 ± 3.6°F for not less than 24 hours. Immediately after exposure to the water spray, the packing list envelope shall be examined. The envelope shall remain securely attached to the piece of wood. Drops of water shall not be present inside the envelope. The simulated packing list shall remain dry enough so that it can be completely unfolded without tearing.

3) Examination of Packaging, Packing, Marking and Palletization. The lot size shall be expressed in units of issue for Packaging, Packing and Marking; and pallets, for palletization. The sample unit shall be 1 fully prepared shipping container or pallet, as applicable. The Inspection Level shall be S-2, the AQL shall be 4.0 percent defective.

3. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS:

The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials in accordance with Public Law 94-580 to the maximum extent practicable.

4. PACKAGING, PACKING, MARKING, AND PALLETIZATION:

Packaging, packing, marking, and palletization shall be as specified in the contract or order.

5. REFERENCED DOCUMENTS:

The issues of the referenced documents in effect on the date of the solicitation for offers or request for proposals shall be used to determine conformance with the requirements of this Commercial Item Description.

A) Public Law

Public Law 94-580 - Resource Conservation and Recovery Act, (Part of U. S. Code, Title 42)

Available from: Congressional Sales Office, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402

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B) Industry Standards

TAPPI T 400 - Sampling and Accepting a Single Lot of Paper, Paperboard, Fiberboard, or Related Product

TAPPI T 403 - Bursting Strength of Paper

TAPPI T 414 - Internal Tearing Resistance of Paper (Elmendorf-type method)

Available from: TAPPI, 15 Technology Parkway South, P. O. Box 105113, Norcross, GA 30092.

ASTM D 951 - Standard Test Method for Water Resistance of Shipping Containers by Spray Method

Available from: ASTM, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

C) Military Standard

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes

Available from: Standardization Documents Order Desk, Building 4D, 700 Robbins Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19111-5094.

6. NOTES:

Purchasers shall specify:

A) Size required, expressed as length X width;

B) Legend required, if any;

C) Packaging, packing, marking, and palletization required.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Military Coordinating Activity

Army - GL

Custodians

Army - GL
Air Force - 69

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

GSA-FSS

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